INFORMATION TO KEEP WITH YOU

# My complete treatment handbook

## Nivolumab · every 2 weeks · advanced melanoma

Understand your treatment. Know what to expect. Keep your plan to hand.

**Displayed calendar**
**14 days**
See the active treatment phase

**Treatment stages**
**1**
Explained in the treatment reference

**Regimen source**
**NCCP 00483**
Version 13a

Reference treatment cycle

## Treatment stages

01 **Ongoing treatment and review**
Every 2 weeks

Your team confirms the active stage and dates. The full treatment guide explains each step.

## Inside your handbook


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**My name**

**Hospital / oncology team**

Use the urgent instructions and contact numbers in your treatment guide. Your team must replace example numbers before patient use. Your individual treatment plan takes precedence.

CHAPTER 01

# Understanding your treatment

IN THIS CHAPTER

Why this treatment is offered, what its medicines do, and how the agreed plan fits your care.

Nivolumab · every 2 weeks · advanced melanoma
National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00483

## When to get help

**Emergency: call 112 / 999**

Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain: call emergency services. Do not wait for an online answer.

**Contact your oncology service immediately**

Temperature 37.5°C or higher, 36°C or lower, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell — even with a normal temperature. Immunotherapy can cause inflammation in healthy organs during treatment or after it stops. Contact the oncology team promptly for new diarrhoea, blood in stools, cough or breathlessness, yellow skin or eyes, severe headache, vision changes, marked thirst, unusual weakness or a spreading rash. Tell any clinician that you are receiving or have received immunotherapy.

Follow the urgent contact instructions from your treating hospital. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Outside clinic hours, use your instructed out-of-hours pathway or the emergency department.

This page does not diagnose symptoms or decide whether it is safe to stay at home. You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

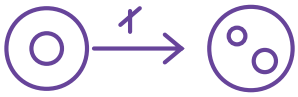
## Medicines in this regimen

Nivolumab helps immune cells act against melanoma that cannot be completely removed or has spread. The aim is disease control; benefit and side effects are reviewed for you.

PD-1 CHECKPOINT IMMUNOTHERAPY

### Nivolumab

Opdivo



**Releases a PD-1 immune brake**

Nivolumab blocks the PD-1 checkpoint that restrains T cells. The resulting immune activity may control melanoma but can also inflame normal organs. Side effects may first appear after the final dose.

PD-1 blocked → Immune activity increases → Healthy organs can inflame

**What to watch for**

Carry your immunotherapy alert card and report new symptoms early, including after treatment ends.

The drawings are simplified explanations of drug action, not anatomical pictures or a prediction of response.

## Understanding your diagnosis and treatment goal

Use these questions with your own pathology report and agreed treatment plan.

### What the diagnosis says

Record the original melanoma site and pathology findings. Breslow thickness and ulceration describe features of the skin tumour; stage describes its extent. Melanoma arising in the eye or a mucosal surface may need a different pathway.

### BRAF and other tumour tests

BRAF V600 testing can identify an alternative targeted-treatment option in some melanomas. It is separate from the immunotherapy described here. Ask what your tumour result means for the choices available to you.



### Surgery, radiotherapy and medicine have different roles

Ask whether medicine is intended to reduce recurrence after complete surgery or control cancer that remains. Add any operation or radiotherapy to the plan with its own purpose, timing and risks.

### Stage and response are different

Stage describes the extent of disease. Response describes a change in measurable cancer during treatment. After complete removal there may be no visible tumour to measure; follow-up then looks for recurrence and treatment effects.



### A new skin change still needs review

Report a new or changing mole, a sore that persists, a new lump or an unexplained symptom. A photo or a good response in one area cannot rule out a separate problem.

## Your medicines and the overall plan

### The schedule in this setting

Nivolumab every 2 weeks. Treatment continues until progression or unacceptable toxicity, with individual benefit and safety review.

### The role of earlier or later treatment

Ask how the medicine fits with previous or planned local treatment. The timing of an operation, radiotherapy and a tablet course should be written in one agreed plan.

### Pauses and stopping

A safety pause is an active treatment decision. Record which medicine is paused, the reason, the tests or recovery needed and who may authorise restarting. Do not restart from an old prescription or reset the history when a new phase begins.

## Questions, decisions and practical support

Your priorities and the burden of treatment belong in the discussion.

### Benefits and uncertainties

Ask what outcome this treatment aims to improve for your diagnosis and what alternatives exist. Results from a study group help a discussion but cannot promise your own result.

### Alternatives and review points

Agree the next decision point and what would make the plan change. Ask about other suitable treatments, trials and symptom care. Support for comfort and function can continue alongside cancer treatment.

### Help with daily life

Tell the team what is hardest in daily life: travel, work, caring duties, costs, sleep or confidence. Ask who can help and how to contact them.

### Shared understanding

Before going home, check that you can describe your medicine schedule, next tests and urgent-contact route. Ask for an interpreter, larger print or a supporter if that would help.

## What the evidence means for your treatment

Discuss the evidence for your diagnosis, tumour test results and treatment setting.

Evidence in advanced melanoma measures control of existing cancer; adjuvant evidence measures recurrence after surgery. Perioperative evidence concerns treatment around surgery. Ask which study and outcome match your stage and plan. These results cannot predict your individual benefit.

CHAPTER 02

# Your schedule, tests and appointments

IN THIS CHAPTER

Your treatment stages, checks and practical preparations, from before treatment through follow-up.

# The overall treatment plan

**Nivolumab · every 2 weeks · advanced melanoma**

14-day view




This shows treatment timing, not guaranteed symptom-free days. Your team confirms the active phase and dates.

EVERY 2 WEEKS

## Ongoing treatment and review

**Day 1 every 14 days** **Duration individually reviewed**

Nivolumab is given as 240 mg by intravenous (IV) infusion over 30 minutes OR 600 mg by subcutaneous injection over 3–5 minutes, on Day 1 every 2 weeks. Allow extra time for assessment, preparation and observation. The team selects one formulation. A subcutaneous injection is given into the thigh or abdomen, alternating sites and avoiding damaged skin, scars or moles. IV and subcutaneous doses are not interchangeable milligram for milligram. Treatment continues until progression or unacceptable toxicity, with individual benefit and safety review.

The team confirms treatment dates, recovery and each safety decision. A planned treatment count does not authorise the next dose.

BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

# Required safety checks and your individual disease-assessment plan

The team supplies actual dates and resolves any source ambiguity. A reference period does not replace a prescription, a local monitoring plan or an individual treatment decision.

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. NCCP 00483 v13a: current regimen source

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

# Nivolumab · every 2 weeks · advanced melanoma: treatment and checks

**Unresectable or metastatic melanoma in adults; the team confirms the source-specific eligibility and previous treatment.**

**Read from left to right.** Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

**Treatment, tests and reviews across the course**

| Care / check | Before starting | During treatment | Between visits | Response / follow-up | After a hold or stop |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Bloods and organ safety** NCCP | Blood count, kidney and liver tests, glucose and thyroid tests; review autoimmune conditions, transplants, previous immune reactions and all current medicines. BRAF tumour status is checked for the advanced or adjuvant melanoma indication. | Blood count, kidney/liver tests and glucose before every 2-week cycle. Thyroid function is checked once a month and when clinically indicated. Cortisol and other tests are added when clinically indicated. Report new symptoms at every visit and between visits; normal blood results do not rule out immune toxicity. | Contact the team for new symptoms; extra tests may be needed between scheduled checks. | Safety bloods do not by themselves show whether cancer is responding. | Continue immune-toxicity monitoring for at least five months after the last dose, and longer when advised. Keep any prescribed steroid taper, hormone replacement and specialist follow-up. Scans follow your individual disease plan. |
| **Cancer, skin and daily function** NCCP | Record diagnosis, stage, current disease sites and the baseline assessment. | Keep the source-specific skin and clinical reviews and the individually agreed response assessments. | Record new lesions, lumps, wound changes, pain and effects on usual activities. | Write the next examination or scan date and the responsible team; no universal scan or tumour-marker interval is assumed. | Your stage, symptoms and treatment determine follow-up. Write down the skin and lymph-node checks, any body or brain scans and the service arranging them. Confirm your own dates with the team. |

| Care / check | Before starting | During treatment | Between visits | Response / follow-up | After a hold or stop |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Medicines and continuing precautions** NCCP | Review all medicines and the pregnancy/ fertility plan. | Review treatment taken or received, holds, adverse effects and supportive medicines. | Keep the actual urgent contacts and do not restart a held medicine yourself. | Bring the medicine list and treatment summary to other services. | Discuss fertility before starting. Use effective contraception during treatment and for at least 5 months after the last dose. Tell the team promptly about a possible pregnancy. Discuss breastfeeding restrictions with the team before treatment; do not breastfeed without their advice. Do not stop prescribed steroids or hormone replacement yourself. |

## What each check is for

1

### Ongoing treatment and review

Every 2 weeks

Nivolumab helps immune cells act against melanoma that cannot be completely removed or has spread. The aim is disease control; benefit and side effects are reviewed for you.

**Ask** / **act:** Confirm the current phase, prescription, tests and support plan.

### At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

## Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

### Taking or receiving treatment

Nivolumab is given as 240 mg by IV infusion over 30 minutes OR 600 mg by subcutaneous injection over 3–5 minutes, on Day 1 every 2 weeks. Allow extra time for assessment, preparation and observation. The team selects one formulation. A subcutaneous injection is given into the thigh or abdomen, alternating sites and avoiding damaged skin, scars or moles. IV and subcutaneous doses are not interchangeable milligram for milligram.

STEP 2

### Missed, vomited or held treatment

If a visit is missed or treatment is held, contact the unit for a new plan. Do not count a missed appointment as a dose received. An interval change, operation or new phase does not erase earlier immune toxicity or a permanent-stop decision.

STEP 3

### Appointments and supply

Plan blood tests, travel and medicine collection in advance. If you need an interpreter or someone to help at home, tell the team before the appointment.

STEP 4

### Paper copies and contact information

Ask for your latest schedule and contact details on paper. Replace old versions when treatment changes so everyone helping you uses the same plan.

## Taking treatment and preparing for visits

Keep the written medicine plan beside this guide; it records your own dose and dates.

### Taking or receiving the medicine

### Other medicines and supplements

Show the pharmacist a current list of prescriptions, over-the-counter medicines, vitamins, herbal products and supplements. Include anticoagulants, heart medicines, steroids and recent antibiotics. Check before adding, stopping or changing anything; an apparently harmless product can alter treatment or confuse a symptom assessment.

### Practical preparation

Bring your medicine list, allergy information and questions. Tell the team about practical problems with travel, swallowing, wound care or remembering doses before treatment starts.

## Follow-up and your continuing record

Keep this record when treatment is paused, changed or completed.

### Your follow-up plan

Your stage, symptoms and treatment determine follow-up. Write down the skin and lymph-node checks, any body or brain scans and the service arranging them. Confirm your own dates with the team.



### Continuing medicine precautions

Continue immune-toxicity monitoring for at least five months after the last dose, and longer when advised. Keep any prescribed steroid taper, hormone replacement and specialist follow-up. Scans follow your individual disease plan.

### Treatment summary for other clinicians

Record the medicines and last dates, important reactions, any long-term hormone replacement or steroid taper, and the responsible oncology contact. Show this information in urgent care and to other specialists. A different treatment phase does not erase earlier toxicity.

### The complete paper version

Use this handbook as your paper record. Keep the current schedule, medicines, tests and contacts together, and replace outdated pages after a change. The matching QR link is optional.

CHAPTER 03

# Symptoms and supportive care

**IN THIS CHAPTER**

Recognising changes, knowing when to call, and using your prescribed supportive-care plan.

## Day 1 → Day 14: a general pattern

This is a visual orientation, not a prediction of your personal cycle. It shows when some effects often emerge and which effects are **not** tied to a particular day.

| Treatment or check | Timing in this view |
|---|---|
| **Nivolumab treatment** |  **Day 1** Nivolumab is given as 240 mg by IV infusion over 30 minutes OR 600 mg by subcutaneous injection over 3–5 minutes, on Day 1 every 2 weeks. Allow extra time for assessment, preparation and observation. The team selects one formulation. A subcutaneous injection is given into the thigh or abdomen, alternating sites and avoiding damaged skin, scars or moles. IV and subcutaneous doses are not interchangeable milligram for milligram. |
| **Symptoms between visits** |  **Days 1–14** Immune effects can begin at any time, including after treatment stops. |
| **Prepare next-cycle review** |  **Day 14** Arrange the required bloods and symptom review before the next dose. Thyroid checks follow their own interval. |

**Your schedule:** Nivolumab every 2 weeks. Treatment continues until progression or unacceptable toxicity, with individual benefit and safety review.

**Tests between visits:** Blood count, kidney/liver tests and glucose before every 2-week cycle. Thyroid function is checked once a month and when clinically indicated. Cortisol and other tests are added when clinically indicated. Report new symptoms at every visit and between visits; normal blood results do not rule out immune toxicity.

**Changing the interval:** If changing from two-weekly to four-weekly nivolumab, the first four-weekly dose is two weeks after the last two-weekly dose. For the reverse change, the first two-weekly dose is four weeks after the last four-weekly dose. The team confirms the formulation and dates.

**Held or missed treatment:** If a visit is missed or treatment is held, contact the unit for a new plan. Do not count a missed appointment as a dose received. An interval change, operation or new phase does not erase earlier immune toxicity or a permanent-stop decision.

**Safety decisions:** Routine dose reductions are not recommended for these immunotherapies. The clinician may hold or stop treatment and treat the immune effect.

**Why these bands stay broad:** This calendar shows the pattern. Your team supplies actual dates, prescribed doses and any hold or restart instructions. Band length does not show likelihood or severity, and the chart cannot tell you whether it is safe to receive treatment. NCCP 00483 v13a: current regimen source ↗

**There are no guaranteed "safe days".** The prescribed dose, treatment decision and local urgent-contact plan take priority. Call 112 or 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse, a new seizure, sudden weakness or speech difficulty, or uncontrolled bleeding. Follow your oncology unit's written urgent-contact plan for other new or worsening symptoms; do not wait for the next appointment.

### Between-treatment notes

### Day 1: Treatment visit

Nivolumab is given as 240 mg by IV infusion over 30 minutes OR 600 mg by subcutaneous injection over 3–5 minutes, on Day 1 every 2 weeks. Allow extra time for assessment, preparation and observation. The team selects one formulation. A subcutaneous injection is given into the thigh or abdomen, alternating sites and avoiding damaged skin, scars or moles. IV and subcutaneous doses are not interchangeable milligram for milligram. Report symptoms and previous reactions before treatment.

### Day 2–14: Between visits

Immunotherapy can cause inflammation in healthy organs during treatment or after it stops. Contact the oncology team promptly for new diarrhoea, blood in stools, cough or breathlessness, yellow skin or eyes, severe headache, vision changes, marked thirst, unusual weakness or a spreading rash. Tell any clinician that you are receiving or have received immunotherapy. Do not wait for the next treatment to report a possible immune effect.

## Support around the medicines

### 1 An individual symptom plan

Ask which anti-sickness or other symptom medicines are prescribed, when to take them and when to call if they do not help. Do not start a borrowed medicine or alter treatment to manage a side effect yourself.

### 2 Your urgent contacts

Keep your actual oncology, out-of-hours and pharmacy contacts on the wallet card. Example numbers on a template must be replaced before you use it.

### 3 Pregnancy and fertility precautions

Discuss fertility before starting. Use effective contraception during treatment and for at least 5 months after the last dose. Tell the team promptly about a possible pregnancy. Discuss breastfeeding restrictions with the team before treatment; do not breastfeed without their advice. Do not stop prescribed steroids or hormone replacement yourself.

### 4 Eating, activity and practical help

Let the team know if cramps, altered taste or poor appetite make eating or moving difficult. Ask for practical food and activity advice that fits your symptoms and any other illness.

### 5 Steroids and hormone replacement

Some immune effects need steroids or lasting hormone replacement. Follow the exact prescription and taper. Carry the relevant alert information, and do not stop or reduce these medicines yourself when anticancer treatment is held or completed.

## Tests: what is required and what each result means

Safety tests, tumour tests and response scans answer different questions.

### Before treatment

Blood count, kidney and liver tests, glucose and thyroid tests; review autoimmune conditions, transplants, previous immune reactions and all current medicines. BRAF tumour status is checked for the advanced or adjuvant melanoma indication.

### During treatment

Blood count, kidney/liver tests and glucose before every 2-week cycle. Thyroid function is checked once a month and when clinically indicated. Cortisol and other tests are added when clinically indicated. Report new symptoms at every visit and between visits; normal blood results do not rule out immune toxicity.



### Scans and tumour markers

Ask the team to write the next assessment and who will arrange it. Bloods used to monitor kidneys, liver, hormones or muscle are not automatically measures of cancer response. There is no universal tumour-marker blood schedule for these skin-cancer regimens; a scan or extra blood test is requested for a specific clinical reason.

### Getting the result

Keep a named contact for bookings and results. If an expected appointment or result is missing, call that service; do not take silence as confirmation that everything is complete.

## What to expect between visits

You can feel well and still need the planned checks. New symptoms deserve attention even on a day without an appointment.

### Your usual pattern

Record the start and change in symptoms, temperature if advised, bowel pattern, drinking, urine and the effect on normal tasks. A simple few-line record is enough. Use it to describe a change rather than trying to grade or diagnose a toxicity yourself.

### Eating, drinking and activity

Report nausea, mouth discomfort, diarrhoea or weight loss before they make eating and drinking difficult. The team can adjust symptom support and arrange dietitian or rehabilitation advice.

## Skin checks, sun protection and optional photographs

This complements clinical assessment and does not replace it.

### Protect your skin

Protect exposed skin with clothing, a hat and shade. Use broad-spectrum sunscreen with sun protection factor (SPF) 30 or higher and reapply as directed. Avoid sunbeds. Cloudy weather does not remove ultraviolet exposure.

### Know the pattern of your skin

Ask the team to show you how to check your skin and treated area. Use a mirror or a helper for areas you cannot see. Report a new lump, a changing lesion or a sore that does not heal.

### Photographs are optional

A private, dated photograph can help describe a change if your team finds it useful. Keep the lighting and size reference consistent. Photographs support a discussion; they do not replace examination and need not be uploaded.

### Wounds, nails and sensitive skin

Follow the wound and skin-care instructions for the treated area. Ask before adding a cream or remedy. Increasing redness, discharge, pain, bleeding or difficulty using the area needs assessment.

## Pregnancy, fertility and protecting others

Discuss these precautions before treatment even if pregnancy is not currently planned.



### Medicine-specific precautions

### Planning ahead

Ask early about fertility preservation, sexual health and symptoms affecting intimacy. Tell the team about any chance of pregnancy, breastfeeding or a partner's pregnancy so that the correct medicine-specific advice can be given. Keep the precautions and their end dates in the written plan.

### Safe handling and supply

Do not share anticancer medicines. Keep oral medicines in their original labelled packaging, away from children and anyone who could take them accidentally. Return unused medicines to the supplying pharmacy and follow its handling advice. A treatment hold does not remove pregnancy precautions.

## Questions worth asking

#### What tests do I need?

Blood count, kidney and liver tests, glucose and thyroid tests; review autoimmune conditions, transplants, previous immune reactions and all current medicines. BRAF tumour status is checked for the advanced or adjuvant melanoma indication. Blood count, kidney/liver tests and glucose before every 2-week cycle. Thyroid function is checked once a month and when clinically indicated. Cortisol and other tests are added when clinically indicated. Report new symptoms at every visit and between visits; normal blood results do not rule out immune toxicity.

#### Who do I call between visits?

Ask the team to enter actual daytime and out-of-hours numbers on the wallet card. Report new symptoms promptly; do not wait for the next appointment.

**Try explaining the plan back:** Can you explain your treatment setting, medicine schedule, next tests, the symptoms that need urgent advice and the number you would call?

**Your diagnosis and treatment setting** Unresectable or metastatic melanoma in adults; the team confirms the source-specific eligibility and previous treatment.

**Supportive prescription draft for review.** This is a regimen template. It is not an issued patient prescription; individual review and completion are required.

## Ongoing treatment and review

**Active medicines:** Nivolumab

**Emetogenic risk:** Minimal

No routine prophylactic antiemetic or premedication is specified for this monotherapy. Any symptom-treatment medicine requires an individual authorised prescription.

### Additional phase-specific support

- Immunotherapy can cause inflammation in healthy organs during treatment or after it stops. Contact the oncology team promptly for new diarrhoea, blood in stools, cough or breathlessness, yellow skin or eyes, severe headache, vision changes, marked thirst, unusual weakness or a spreading rash. Tell any clinician that you are receiving or have received immunotherapy.
- Discuss fertility before starting. Use effective contraception during treatment and for at least 5 months after the last dose. Tell the team promptly about a possible pregnancy. Discuss breastfeeding restrictions with the team before treatment; do not breastfeed without their advice. Do not stop prescribed steroids or hormone replacement yourself.
- Immune adverse effects may require corticosteroids and/or long-term hormone replacement under specialist direction. Do not stop prescribed treatment yourself.
- This is an incomplete clinical/pharmacy review draft, not an issued prescription.

**Before signing:** verify allergies, current medicines, interactions, renal / hepatic function, QT risk, sedation, prior response, total steroid exposure and the rescue-medicine duration. Do not duplicate medicines from another phase.

Individual changes / rescue duration: _____
Prescriber / date: _____ Pharmacy review: _____

# What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

### 1 Hormones / head / eyes

**Nivolumab**

New severe headache, visual change, unusual tiredness, dizziness, thirst or frequent urination may signal immune effects and needs prompt advice.

### 3 Heart / muscles

**Nivolumab**

Chest pain, palpitations, marked muscle weakness or swallowing difficulty can be serious immune effects. Seek urgent assessment.

### 5 Kidneys / urine

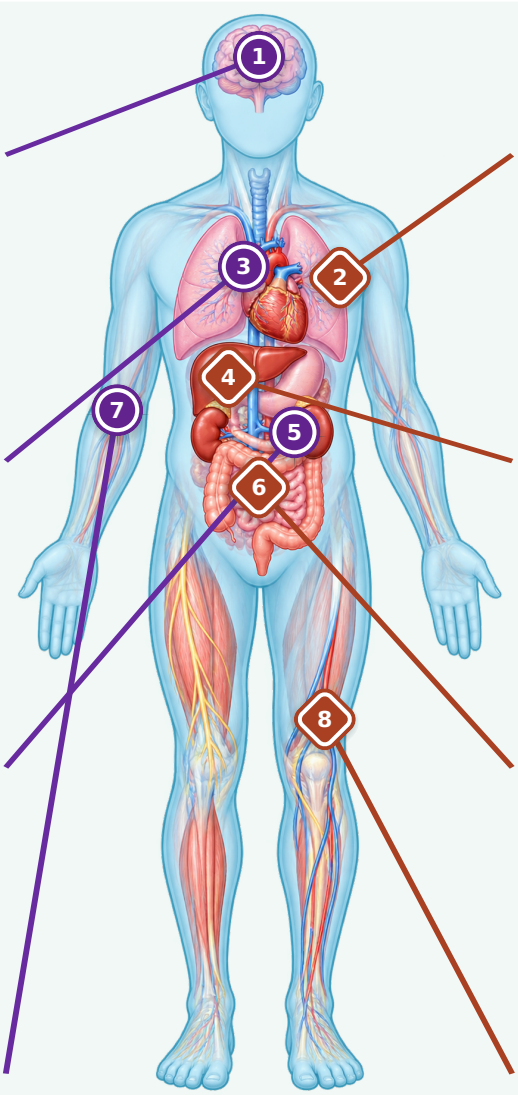
**Nivolumab**

Kidney inflammation may be detected on blood tests. Report reduced urine, swelling, blood in urine or a marked change from normal.

### 7 Skin / mouth

**Nivolumab**

Report rash or itching early. Blistering, peeling, mouth or genital sores, or rash with fever needs urgent assessment.




### 2 Lungs / breathing

**Nivolumab**

New cough or breathlessness may reflect lung inflammation or another serious cause. Call promptly; severe breathing difficulty is an emergency.

### 4 Liver

**Nivolumab**

Inflammation may first show in blood tests. Report yellow eyes or skin, dark urine, unusual itching or upper-abdominal pain.

### 6 Bowels / abdomen

**Nivolumab**

Report increased stool frequency, diarrhoea, blood or mucus, or abdominal pain early. Severe pain, black stools or dehydration needs urgent help.

### 8 Nerves / strength

**Nivolumab**

New tingling, weakness, unsteadiness, facial change or trouble swallowing needs prompt review. Sudden weakness or speech difficulty is an emergency.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Immunotherapy can cause inflammation in healthy organs during treatment or after it stops. Contact the oncology team promptly for new diarrhoea, blood in stools, cough or breathlessness, yellow skin or eyes, severe headache, vision changes, marked thirst, unusual weakness or a spreading rash. Tell any clinician that you are receiving or have received immunotherapy.

**When to get help**

**Call 112 / 999** for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

**Call oncology immediately:** temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

**Oncology daytime:** 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

**EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.**

CHAPTER 04

# Your record and contact card

IN THIS CHAPTER

Space for your own cycle or review record, questions and notes, followed by your treatment card.

> Record each cycle separately. Each medicine has its own symptom table. Mark the worst symptoms since your last review, when they occurred and what they stopped you doing. Overlapping symptoms can be recorded under more than one medicine; you do not have to identify the cause.
>
> These are patient-language severity prompts, not a validated questionnaire or a formal Common Terminology Criteria for Adverse Events (CTCAE) grading tool. Your team assigns the clinical grade. Serious symptoms override the columns: call without waiting to decide a severity level.
>
> Use a new record sheet for each cycle or review. Copy or print another sheet when needed; the number of sheets does not prescribe the length of treatment.
>
> Draft source reconciliation; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

# My diagnosis, plan and medicines

Complete these pages with your team. Leave unknown or inapplicable items blank. This record supports the consent discussion and your written prescription.

## Diagnosis and overall plan

**Original melanoma site / pathology date**

**Stage / Breslow thickness / ulceration**

**Lymph-node or other disease sites**

**BRAF result / date / other relevant tumour tests**

**Advanced or adjuvant intent / earlier surgery or radiotherapy (RT)**

## Medicines and safety

**Anticancer medicines / actual dose / route / start date**

**Treatment received, missed or held / restart instruction**

**All other medicines / allergies / important previous reactions**

**Pregnancy-prevention or immune-alert plan / continuing precautions**

**Oncology / out-of-hours / pharmacy contacts**

SACTCheck patient information. Your team confirms your personal plan. The treatment reference collects the clinical and medicine sources.

## My checks, symptoms and support

Record what each test is checking and when the result will be discussed. Your team explains which examinations or scans are needed for your diagnosis and treatment.

| Test and purpose | Date / booking contact | Result discussion | Agreed next step |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |

Record bloods, skin/lesion examinations, scans and specialist checks separately. Tumour-marker and scan intervals are individually selected; do not infer them from the cycle calendar.

### Symptoms, skin and support

**New symptoms / onset / change / action taken**

**Lesion or wound / pain / eating / weight / daily function**

**Skin self-check plan / optional dated photograph record kept privately**

**Sun protection / practical, emotional or family support needs**

**Questions, response review and the outcomes that matter to me**

**My urgent contact plan / what my carer should do**

SACTCheck patient information. Your team confirms your personal plan. The treatment reference collects the clinical and medicine sources.

Cycle number: _____ Start date: _____ Next review: _____

Record the actual date, treatment received, any hold, important symptom and the next check. A review visit is not automatically a medicine dose or a completed cycle.

**Ongoing treatment and review: Every 2 weeks** · copy this sheet for another cycle of the same phase.

### Nivolumab · PD-1 checkpoint immunotherapy

| Symptom | None | Mild | Moderate / call | Severe / urgent | Emergency signs |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Bowels** | □ Usual pattern | □ New change: report | □ Persistent diarrhoea / constipation: call | □ Blood, severe pain or dehydration: urgent review | □ Collapse or severe sudden illness: 112/999 |
| **Breathing** | □ Usual breathing | □ New cough / change: call | □ Worsening breathlessness: urgent advice | □ Breathless at rest: urgent assessment | □ Severe breathing difficulty: 112/999 |
| **Skin** | □ No change | □ New small change: report | □ Persistent rash / itch: contact team | □ Painful, spreading or blistering rash: urgent review | □ Severe skin reaction with acute illness: emergency help |
| **Fatigue** | □ Usual energy | □ Tiredness improves with rest | □ Rest does not help; usual tasks affected: call | □ Self-care difficult: urgent review | □ Collapse: 112/999 |

Dates / doses missed or changed / symptoms affecting daily life / questions:

> Red flags override the table. Fever, shivers, suddenly unwell, chest symptoms or inability to drink: seek prompt advice. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse or severe chest pain: 112 / 999.

# Keep your treatment details to hand

**Unresectable or metastatic melanoma in adults; the team confirms the source-specific eligibility and previous treatment.** · NCCP 00483 v13a · Document revised 6 November 2026

Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

**FRONT / CONTACTS**

## My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

**Nivolumab · melanoma**

Every 2 weeks; duration reviewed with your team.

Phase: _____ Cycle plan: team to confirm

**Daytime (EXAMPLE)** 087 12345678

**Out of hours (EXAMPLE)** 087 87654321

**Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.**
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

**BACK / TREATMENT RECORD**

## My cycle record

Rolling record — continue on your agreed plan.

| Cycle | Date / initials |
|---|---|
| | |
| | |
| | |
| | |

My treatment information

Latest treatment date: _____

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

CUT outer border

**FOLD centre — do not cut**

## Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

## Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

### iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

### Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

## Your local contacts and resources

**Oncology daytime:** 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

**EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.**

Hospital / team: _____

Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.

CHAPTER 05

# Sources and further information

## IN THIS CHAPTER

The references behind this information and addresses you can use to find further help.

Use this information alongside the plan agreed with your treatment team. Your team confirms your medicines, doses and appointments.

1. **National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00483 v13a: current regimen source**
   https://healthservice.hse.ie/documents/6498/483_Nivolumab_14-day_.pdf
2. **EMA: Opdivo medicine overview**
   https://www.ema.europa.eu/en/medicines/human/EPAR/opdivo
3. **NCI: melanoma — patient information**
   https://www.cancer.gov/types/skin/patient/melanoma-treatment-pdq
4. **NCI: melanoma treatment — clinical evidence**
   https://www.cancer.gov/types/skin/hp/melanoma-treatment-pdq
5. **NCI: eating and nutrition during cancer treatment**
   https://www.cancer.gov/about-cancer/treatment/side-effects/nutrition
6. **NCI: palliative care during cancer treatment**
   https://www.cancer.gov/about-cancer/advanced-cancer/care-choices/palliative-care-fact-sheet
7. **NCI: skin cancer — patient information**
   https://www.cancer.gov/types/skin/patient/skin-treatment-pdq
8. **HSE SunSmart: protection from sun and sunbeds**
   https://www.hse.ie/conditions/cancer/protect-skin-sun-sunbeds/